

Video Transcript

Video 5: Cookies (05:50)

So, we've already seen how to deal with session cookies, but let's take a look at placing our own ordinary cookie on the browser. So, in this case, we do it almost by hand. The session cookie was handled automatically behind the scenes by Flask. But here we're going to have to set the cookie, give it to the browser, the browser will then store it. And every time it hits us, the web server that is, it'll pass that cookie back to us. So, let's take a look at the code. So, here we are. So, we're in login and they're registering and we check the user and if they've passed the test that they're in our list of users, then we're going to set up a cookie and pass it back to them.

So, let's take a look how that works. The first thing we need to do though is to create a response because we're going to need to add the cookie by hand to the response. We didn't have to do this with the session cookie, but here I'm using make response, we have to load that in Flask. So, here I'm adding make response. We now render the template and we capture the response. Now what we're going to do is add the cookie to the response. So, we have response set cookie, and then we give it a name, and then we say what we want to store in that name, and I'm just storing here the username. Again, we can store anything we want. Cookies are often used, for example, when you're putting things into a shopping basket, they'll store the shopping basket as a cookie so that when you come back to them, they know exactly what's in the shopping basket. But here I'm just going to store the username. Now, we can return response. So, that's the login part. Now, the cookie has been set. Now when they, for example, come back to books, we need to go and get that cookie out of their request that they're now sending to us as the web server. So, what we do is we, out of the request, we pull out cookies, we do cookies.get and then we need to know the name.

So, I'm calling it my session cookie. So, whatever name you're using for your cookie, this is where we pull it out and we're going to store it for now in user. And now what we need to do is we just return to them, render books, and we're going to include the username when we render that books.html. So, that's our try block because maybe the cookie hasn't been set, in which case we need to add to it this except, okay? And we send them back to register.html. Let's take a look at

this running, so let's save that and let's go to the debug. Okay, so we're running. Let's go and take a look at the browser. So, let's go to localhost: 5000. Here we are.

Remember, we need to look under settings and we can bring up, right down here. We can take a look at our cookies. So, here cookies and site data and then clear cookies. But, let's take a look. I want to see all the cookies. There we go. Let's remove them all. So, now I have no cookies. Let's register and submit. It's got us as test user and if we hit list books, we'll get the books. So, let's go and have a look at the cookies now. And already we've got a few, but here's our localhost one and you see it's called my session cookie and inside the content is test user. So, that's our cookie being set and pass back. It's passing our check here. Let's just go back to the code and put in a break point. So, we'll just put in a break point here. Let's go back and hit 'list books'. So, here we are requesting the session cookie and we'll see that user is test user. So, we're getting our cookie back. So, that's how to set ordinary pure cookies and like I say, they're very useful if you want to store data such as a shopping cart, you can store it as a cookie. Okay, bye for now.

